

HP Victus 16-r0075TX

High performance, awesome cooling, but low storage

Spoiler alert! I am very impressed with the new and improved HP Victus 16. Not

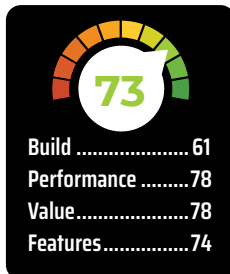
only has HP fixed some of the most annoying flaws since the previous generation but it has managed to retain all those things which made the Victus series great in the first place. For the uninitiated, the Victus is the affordable gaming laptop series from HP whose main purpose is to deliver high value for money gaming performance. As a result, HP has strategically placed Victus gaming laptops from as low as Rs 55,000 to upwards of Rs 1.30 lakh. And while in earlier generations HP went with a one-size fits all approach with its series by using a single design for its lower and higher-end Victus laptops. The brand has all but abandoned it in its newer series. Because now, these laptops come in different colour options and most importantly different sizes. So what is new in the new HP Victus 16? Here's everything you need to know.

DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, KEYBOARD, AND TRACKPAD

The main thing I noticed about the new Victus series, apart from the new design, is how the hinge works just so much better than the previous generation. It stays in its position, doesn't shake when I type furiously, and can even manage to lift the laptop's base if you lift it with one hand. Meanwhile, the hinge on the earlier generation suffered, like a damsel in distress, from all these annoying problems. But now it's fixed.

The design is the second thing worth mentioning here. Mainly because it is subtle and impactful. From afar, both laptops will look almost similar. But

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small changes all over the chassis completely change the way you use the laptop. For example, the corners of the laptop are now not as sharp and it makes a noticeable impact on your typing experience. As these edges do not pierce your wrists as much as before. You'll

also notice that in the new Victus, the keyboard area is placed well within a carved-out area and there is also an indent point in its chassis to allow you to easily lift the lid. The trackpad and the keyboard typing experience remain the same, which is a good thing because it was stellar, to begin with.

But I have to mention that HP still uses a full-size keyboard. A 60% keyboard is a personal choice for many, but so is a gaming laptop with a Numpad. The choice of whether to install a full-size or a 60% keyboard essentially boils down to what the consumers want. Although, I don't feel that the current setup lacks in any way. The keys are spaced apart quite neatly and have good travel to them. The 16-inch laptop is big

enough so I have ample palm area to rest my hands as well.

Now, HP uses only plastic and polycarbonate material all around the laptop. And it is a good thing because of two reasons. Firstly, the plastic used is very sturdy and also premium so you'll not end up with scratches all over it. Secondly, plastic is much better for a gaming laptop because plastic acts as a better insulator and helps to keep the laptop's surface cool. You don't have to worry about that trapped heat either because the fans on HP Victus make short work of it. More on that later in the article.

And lastly, in terms of ports, the laptop comes with a USB Type-C/Thunderbolt 4 port, three USB Type-A SuperSpeed ports, an HDMI out port, an RJ 45 ethernet slot, and a 3.5mm audio jack. What's missing on the HP Victus 16, which you can find in the most affordable Victus 15, is a full-size SD card slot. The Victus 16 we're discussing here is pretty powerful and will most likely find its use in content creation as well, therefore giving it an SD card slot should have been a no-brainer.

DISPLAY, SPEAKERS AND WEBCAM

The HP Victus 16 comes with a 16.1 FHD display with support for a maximum refresh rate of 165Hz. The IPS LCD screen has an Anti-glare coating, which makes it a joy to use in indoor environments, especially where there are a lot of overhanging lights. In terms of display tests, I found that the screen has a peak brightness of 315 nits with 99% sRGB coverage and around 76% DCI-P3 coverage. The average Delta E of the screen is around 3.2 making it decently colour-accurate. And if you primarily make content for the web then this HP Victus will surely suffice.

The laptop also has a 178-degree viewing angle and you can actually see good colours even if you're looking at the screen from sideways. The 315 nits of brightness is enough for working indoors and in a sunlight-filled room.